



Understanding Pre-Approval

Understand the process, make smart decisions, and move forward with confidence.



1. GET PREPARED

Gather essentials and set clear goals.



2. SHARE & REVIEW

Your loan team reviews your financial picture.



3. EVALUATE

We assess options and determine what you qualify for.



4. GET PRE-APPROVED

Receive a pre-approval letter with confidence.



5. MOVE FORWARD

Shop smart and make strong offers.



INSIDE THIS GUIDE

What pre-approval really means, how it differs from pre-qualification, what your loan team reviews, what can change, and your clear next steps.



What Pre-Approval Really Means

Pre-approval is a lender's preliminary review of your financial information to estimate how much you may be able to borrow.

- 1 A strong planning step**
It shows sellers you are a serious buyer and helps you shop with more confidence.
- 2 Not a guarantee**
Final approval depends on the property, updated financial information, and the full underwriting review.
- 3 A point in time**
Pre-approval is based on today's information — not a promise for the future.
- 4 A team effort**
You, your loan officer, and your real estate agent work together to create the best plan.

BIG IDEA Pre-approval gives you clarity to move forward wisely — not a guarantee that everything is already done.

Pre-Qualification vs. Pre-Approval

They are not the same — and the difference matters when you make an offer.

Pre-Qualification	Pre-Approval
Based on information you provide	Based on documents and a lender review
Quick and informal	More detailed and reliable
Not verified	Verified financial information
Helpful for early planning	Stronger when making an offer
Not a commitment	Still not a guarantee, but a better indicator

PLANNER TIP Always get pre-approval — not just pre-qualification — before making offers on homes.

What Your Loan Team Reviews

Your loan team reviews key pieces of your financial picture to determine how much home you may be able to buy.

Income

Stability, history, and documentation of earnings.

Assets

Bank accounts, savings, and funds available for closing.

Credit

Credit history, scores, payment history, and existing obligations.

Debts

Monthly payments — loans, credit cards, and other obligations.

Property

The type of home you want to buy and its intended use.

Rates & Programs

Rates change daily and programs have specific requirements.

Why Your Budget Still Matters

Just because you are pre-approved for a certain amount does not mean that is the right amount for you.

- 1 Comfort is personal**
Your monthly payment should fit your life, not stretch it.

- 2 Plan for the full picture**
Include taxes, insurance, HOA, utilities, maintenance, and lifestyle.

- 3 Protect your future**
Budgeting wisely today helps you avoid financial stress tomorrow.

BIG IDEA Pre-approval helps you know what you can do. Your budget helps you decide what you should do.

What Can Change After Pre-Approval

Many things can affect your final approval — keep your team informed before you make changes.

1

Interest rates

Rates can go up or down and affect your purchasing power.

2

Credit activity

New credit, large charges, or late payments can impact results.

3

Job or income changes

Changing jobs or a reduction in income matters.

4

Large purchases or deposits

Big purchases or unexplained deposits can cause delays.

5

Property issues

Appraisal, condition, or property type can impact approval.

Your Next Steps

- 1 Get pre-approved**
Connect with your loan team and gather your documents.

- 2 Share with your agent**
Mary can help you find homes that fit your plan.

- 3 Shop with confidence**
Make offers with a strong plan and smart strategy.

- 4 Stay in touch**
Keep your loan team updated on any changes.

Let's create your plan together.

Schedule your free strategy call at movewithmaryv.com